

Applying Your Analysis Device

- a. Now we will begin classifying the responses based on our Bales IPA-based chart above. After reading through each response, we will check our chart; attempt to match each complete idea to the category it best fits, keeping the count for that category.
- b. Here is an example of how we classified some of the comments that appear.

Example 1:

**Greg DeVore** says:
[February 2, 2012 at 9:14 am](#)

I like this a lot and it falls in line with what we have been telling our customers for quite awhile now.

We tell our customers a lot of things but as we have gone back and interviewed the most successful ones, without fail, they mention that this approach of creating documentation after release has been the biggest key to their success. It completely changes the way you write and use documentation.

And you are right. You can't launch with no documentation at all. But you can launch with a minimal set and then grow it as needed.

Question for you though – how has this affected the tools you choose to use to author and deliver your docs?

BTW – we just posted a video that discusses this type of approach this morning on our blog:

<http://www.bluemangolearning.com/blog/2012/02/docs-that-rock-whiteboard-video-do-it-dont-finish-it/>

We can see from the first sentence that Greg is praising the article so this we classified as a category 1.

The second paragraph contains several sentences with the first showing agreement with evidence he complies with the article. "We tell our customers...biggest key to success." Category 3. The second sentence we took to showing some concurrence with the author so also category 3.

The third paragraph is similar to the second in our opinion; agreement followed by compliance with the stated idea, so categories 1, 3, and 3.

The fourth paragraph is different from just agreeing with the author. It is asking a question, but what kind? We decided he is asking for direct information, not an opinion direction; so category 2 here.

Finally, the fifth paragraph, the responder is giving other readers additional information. While he is directing others to this site, is more as a way of presenting information, so we will say category 4 here.

Example 2:

**Tammy P** says:
[February 2, 2012 at 4:29 pm](#)

I hate to be out of step with the rest here, but I have serious concerns about this approach. The biggest is that once users have gone to the help or docs (which is far more likely when a release is new to them) and *not* found an answer, they are less likely to come back – they'll look elsewhere. So you lose your ability to help them in the future and save them and your company time and money. I think increasing our emphasis on improving docs based on customer feedback after a release is essential, but I don't think releasing with minimal docs and then filling in the details later is the way to go. Sorry!

This post of Tammy's is a great example of a response riding the bottom end of the IPA chart without being rude.

The first sentence shows clear disagreement but in a polite and formal way. Category 1

The second sentence shows her giving her evaluation of the problem. While in support of a disagreement, it is not antagonistic or inquisitive. Category 5.

The third sentence is a continuation of this evaluation but we thought it was more for clarification than an evaluation. Category 6.

The fourth sentence begins with a great tell, "I think...". A great sign for category 5 and the rest of the sentence we feel carries on with this idea.

Remember above when we explained that IPA could consider simple sentences or even single word responses? Here we are! Now "Sorry!" cannot be interpreted as a question as an attempt to answer one. Reading the entire response and taking it in context we believe it is part of the disagreement with the author, but since it is on the 'nice' end of the spectrum, we called this a category 10 disagreement.

- c. Keep track of the count in any way you wish, the important thing to do here is to try and remain as constant as you can in categorizing these communications. As you will come to see, this is where the unreliability of sentiment analysis comes into play.

Note: Be sure to disregard any posts created by the posts owner or moderator. We are interested in outside opinions only. Bloggers often respond to comments left on their posts. This is a good way to encourage feedback in readers and build a fan base, but it is not something that should be measured here. Responses to these author posts are another matter and since they are reader posts, **should** still be counted.